

Teach Me Master

Artificial neural networks mimic biological learning behaviour. These are composed of simple processing elements called neurons, which display dynamic behaviour based on the information that passes through the network. A rough example: a neural-network might be able to tell the parts of speech of a sentence given lots of sample sentences and their parts of speech. It would be able to do this because it can “get” analogies, unlike systems that are hard-coded into saying that the result is either this or that.

April: The IC Is Patented—Noyce Gets It

The Integrated Circuit (IC), invented in 1958, was patented. Both (independent) inventors applied for the patent—Kilby from Texas Instruments, who called it “Solid Circuit,” and Noyce from Fairchild Semiconductor, who called it “Unitary Circuit.” The patent was awarded to the latter. The term “chip,” used for an IC, is derived from the single piece of silicon holding the circuit. The first chip contained one transistor, one capacitor, and three resistors. Thanks to the space-saving nature of the invention, ICs rapidly gained in popularity and contributed to the reduction in sizes of many components.

April: The High-performance Stretch

IBM delivered the “Stretch” 7030 computer to Los Alamos Scientific Laboratories, which was at the forefront of US Nuclear weapons research. Stretch was the codename for the high-performance computers manufactured by IBM starting with the 7030. Its use of eight-bit bytes popularised the concept at a time when byte size was subjective.

June: Pioneering Work In Hard Disks

The IBM 1301 Disk Drive was introduced. It pioneered many concepts still in use in today’s hard disks, like individual read/write heads for each platter, the cylinder concept, sliding movement of heads, etc. The 1310 had a spindle speed of 1800 rpm and a storage capacity of 28 million characters.

October: The Desktop Electronic Calculator

The first desktop electronic calculator, ANITA (“A New Inspiration To Accounting” or “A New Inspiration To Arithmetic”) was